

and transparent—otherwise, many of the benefits of the solution will flow to advisors, asset managers, and Uncle Sam.

To help facilitate the DIY solution, our firm, Alpha Architect, has a set of free tools to facilitate much of the analysis conducted throughout this book. We encourage you to visit the site to learn more: AlphaArchitect.com. We provide this service because it is directly in line with our firm's mission: *To Empower Investors Through Education*. We will provide monthly signals for the risk-management rules to help investors stick to the model (simply go to our website each month)!

And while we have an inspirational mission and a strongly held belief that we can disrupt the financial services industry for the better, it is important to note that we are a for-profit enterprise and have vested interests. We want to be fully transparent on this point: While we encourage and facilitate DIY investors, our firm does implement the DIY approach for clients and we charge fees for these services.

More importantly, we sponsor active strategies that capture the value and momentum anomalies, and for executing these strategies we charge a fee. Our products are meant to provide the “plugs” for value and momentum exposures suggested in the DIY framework, or any framework that seeks to exploit value and momentum strategies. However, one can also implement these stock strategies via trading the individual stocks in their brokerage account, thus eliminating any management fees we might charge. We encourage DIY investors to take this approach if they want the challenge and are indifferent to taxes. For those less inclined to run an internal asset management firm, and for those with taxable assets, we believe our strategies are unique in that they are tax-efficient, affordable, and truly active (less than 50 stock portfolios).

We hope you enjoyed the book and explore our tools and our research. We welcome your feedback on how we can improve our tools and help empower investors through education.

Notes

¹ Jean-Louis Dessales, “Simplicity Theory” (September 9, 2014), <http://www.simplicitytheory.org/>.